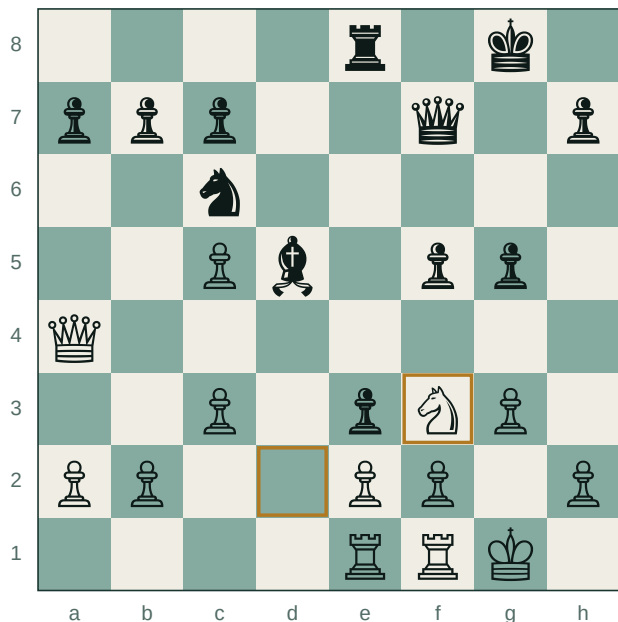


Advanced-pawn tactics: Black, move 20

Advanced-pawn tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 20.Nf3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

20...Bxf3 21. exf3 e2 22. Rxe2 Rxe2

20...Bxf3 The bishop captures the knight on f3. Recorded reply: **21.exf3**.

21...e2 The pawn moves from e3 to e2. Recorded reply: **22.Rxe2**.

22...Rxe2 The rook captures the rook on e2.

At the end, nominal material is White 22 / Black 23 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +4. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +4:** the balance goes from -3 to +1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A far-advanced pawn may be weak if unsupported. Check whether the opponent can capture it with tempo or blockade it permanently.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A pawn near promotion forces the defender to respect urgent threats. Its strength can create forks, deflections, or mating ideas even when it never actually promotes.

HOW TO LOOK

Count the remaining pushes and identify the blocker. Look for forcing moves that remove or distract that blocker.

The defending king is on g1. Geometrically undefended: queen on a4. Check for tactical protection.